Saja Lutfi

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Professional Summary

Human-Computer Interaction master's student with a background in Cognitive Science and Software Design. Experienced in UX research, interaction design, and bilingual (English-Arabic) product design. Skilled in Figma prototyping, user interviews, and translating research into actionable design decisions.

Education

University of Maryland College Park, MD
Master of Science in Human-Computer Interaction. *Expected 05/28*
Relevant Coursework: Programming Human-Centered Interfaces, Fundamentals of Human-Computer Interaction, User Experience Research Methods

University of Connecticut Storrs, CT
Bachelor of Arts in Cognitive Science. Minor: Software Design. *05/26*
Relevant Coursework: Business Software Development, Business Information Systems, Intro to Computing for Engineers, Statistics, Symbolic Logic, UI/UX Design

Experience

Marketing Manager Assistant January 2024 – Present
ZViolet Trading LLC *Alexandria, VA*

- Design wireframes, digital layouts, and user-facing content to improve clarity and usability across digital platforms.
- Create interactive prototypes in Figma and iterate on designs using audience feedback and engagement data.
- Analyze user engagement and content performance to guide design decisions, contributing to a 30% increase in audience interaction.

Student Researcher May 2025 – June 2025
Summer Interdisciplinary Ethnography Field School *Mauritius, Africa*

- Conducted qualitative field research through interviews, participant observation, and field notes to explore identity, ritual, and cultural preservation.
- Documented community perspectives, including those of the Chagos Refugee Group, on displacement and cultural memory.
- Synthesized field observations and interviews into a final research paper on ritual traditions and cultural memory.

Projects

Nile Health Network
UX Research & Design

- Designed a bilingual nonprofit website concept focused on health and humanitarian resources for communities affected by the conflict in Sudan.
- Gathered 10 survey responses and conducted 3 interviews to identify information needs, trust factors, and user expectations.
- Translated research findings into information architecture, wireframes, and an interactive Figma prototype featuring multilingual content, impact reporting, and donation flows.

Horizon Farm Credit Fall 2026 – Present
UX Research | Graduate Client Project | In Progress

- Collaborating on a graduate team project exploring how Agricultural Lending employees use internal data, reports, and dashboards.
- Identifying opportunities to improve employee workflows and make reporting tools easier to use.

UConn Nexus Redesign
UX Research & Design

- Evaluated a university platform to identify issues with navigation, information hierarchy, and student usability.
- Redesigned key screens with clearer navigation, a centered login, and greater visibility of the Hub.

Activities & Leadership

UConn Cognitive Collective February 2025 - May 2026
Founder & President

- Founded and led a Cognitive Science student organization; organized faculty discussions, networking events, and career programming.

Skills

Design: Figma, Adobe XD, Wireframing, Interactive Prototyping, Interface Design, Information Architecture
Research: User Interviews, Surveys, Usability Testing, Contextual Inquiry, Affinity Mapping, Journey Mapping, User Archetypes, Qualitative Research
Web & Technical: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, Java, C#, Visual Studio Code, GitHub Pages, Excel
Languages: English, Arabic